

**ZUCKERBERG IS
CEO B******

Facebook's acquisition of Instagram is said to have been pursued by Mark Zuckerberg alone. Board members were notified only hours before the deal was set to close. Here's how the billion dollar deal happened <http://dgit.in/JcqMya>

**WORLD'S TOTAL CPU
POWER: ONE HUMAN
BRAIN**

Researchers have tracked changes in 60 different analog and digital technologies, from newsprint to cellular data, for a period of over 20 years <http://dgit.in/lHqrAl>

**RAIDERS OF THE LOST
ARCHIVES**

The creator of Ubisoft game franchise *Prince of Persia*, Jordan Mechner, found an old floppy with the original source code written in 6502 assembly language on it. Now it's being made Open Source. Read on for the full story <http://dgit.in/JWULWo>

**THE CREEPIEST APPS
AND SITES**

A look at five apps that severely infringe on what constitutes privacy in the digital era. These apps crawl social networks, download images and fetch location data of their intended targets <http://dgit.in/JhhvSe>

Who Owns You Online?

Your data is your digital replica but it may not be your own

- By Chandra Steele



Copyright © 2011
Ziff Davis Publishing
Holdings Inc.

As dispassionate as it sounds, a person's data is their digital replica. Though there are thousands of traits that make someone unique, a binarily-coded identity is the only verifiable one, making it arguably the most lasting and meaningful. As the singularity gets nearer and nearer, technology could conceivably be responsible for the legal definition of personhood being extended, and therefore, the protection of our digital selves is of immediate concern.

Jotting down thoughts, speaking a few words, (<http://dgit.in/JwPXav>) and just taking a drive (<http://dgit.in/lloFFx>) are no longer ephemeral activities, they're defining ones.

"I think the format of [social media] makes sharing feel contagious and it normalizes a level of self-involvement and transmission of details that would previously have just been considered weird," says Ari Melber, correspondent for The Nation (<http://dgit.in/lZiFzL>).

How much control do we have over these pieces of ourselves, whether we've given them away freely or they've been snatched without our knowledge?

Data

Data has always been made up of 1s and 0s but now those numbers fall behind a dollar sign. Facebook's valuation of nearly \$100

billion is built on little else but its users' data. (<http://dgit.in/lcpEWi>) Likewise, Google is an advertising company (<http://dgit.in/JvIFIO>) that's model relies on the input and monitoring of millions to earn the \$38 billion in revenue it took in last year, 96 percent of which was from ads.

Using Google's services entitles the company to "use, host, store, reproduce, modify, create derivative works,...communicate, publish, publicly perform, publicly display and distribute" a user's content in perpetuity, even after the user has disengaged from those services.



Terms of use policies for social networking sites, including Facebook and Twitter, frequently have similar wording that grants the companies, and to whom ever they decide to sell it, the rights to "IP content" (i.e., user photos, personal information, status updates, comments, etc.) in a "non-exclusive, transferable, sub-licensable, royalty-free, worldwide license" (i.e., that is the right to share in the use of and to sell the use of it, including for profit and without

payment) agreement. It's a policy that has led to people becoming pitchmen for things they'd rather not be associated with (<http://dgit.in/lOhHKj>) in Facebook ads.

"I think the line between technically, legally using people's information and stealing their content in ways they didn't knowingly consent to is a line that has more to do with perception than law," Melber says.

So while it may come as a surprise to many to discover their photos are popping up in ads across their network of friends, it's only the beginning of how their information is being used. Sponsored ads are also public, while the many other ways a digital identity is sliced, diced, packaged, and sold are not.

"They have what many would consider a very aggressive reading of their control over not only all of their users' content but also all of their ex-users," Melber says. "We've got a lot of companies here who not only don't allow you to opt out, but once you opt in, like Hotel California, you can never leave."

Terms of service can—and do—change frequently and without direct notification to users. To keep up to date on what they've signed up for, it's up to users to constantly check the terms of service on the sites where they share information. Continued use of the site, whether or not the users have reviewed the terms, constitutes agreement to whatever makes its way into the policies.

Melber mentions that some, such as Zipcar founder Robin Chase, (<http://www.robinchase.org/>) think the day may be coming where users are paid by sites like Facebook